Hawk/Dove Scoring Rubric

Version: v2 (19 Oct 2026)
Built from: 126 statements labelled by Ollie (gold set v1.1), 99 train / 24 holdout / 3 retired
Tested: v0 blind test on 27 holdout statements: 37% exact, 78% within 1 point, average gap 1.0, scorer 0.6 points too dovish. v1 blind test on 30 fresh statements: 33% exact, 77% within 1, average gap 1.1, scorer nearer 0 than Ollie on 13 of 16 same-side statements (87% within 1 after Ollie corrected 2 slips and relabelled 3, not blind). v2 not yet tested.
Applies to: Bank of England MPC, Bank of Japan Policy Board

This file is the instruction set the scorer follows for every statement. Anchor examples are drawn only from the training split, so the holdout stays a fair test.

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1. Purpose and scope

Score a single statement by one policymaker for what it signals about **their preferred path for the policy rate**.

In scope: views on the rate path, the pace of moves, the neutral rate, inflation persistence, the balance of risks, and the policy stance (tight, restrictive, accommodative). For the BoJ, also JGB purchases where tied to the stance.

Out of scope, return `not_policy`: financial stability, payments, regulation, CBDC, AI, institutional history, unless the speaker ties it to the rate path.

2. Reference frame (the most important rule)

Hawkish means wanting tighter policy than markets currently expect. Dovish means wanting looser policy than markets currently expect.

Every scoring call is given a context block:

```
Bank:                BoE
Date:                2026-09-24
Policy rate:         3.75%
Last decision:       hold, 6-3 (3 for a hike)
Market-implied path: +97bp over 12 months (from baseline_<date>.json)
Speaker's last vote: hold
```

Score against that block, not against an absolute idea of tight or loose. The same words can score differently in different contexts.

3. The scale

Whole numbers only. If torn between two levels, choose the one closer to 0 and lower the confidence. This is for genuine ties only, when two levels fit equally well; it is not a general lean toward 0. When the words clearly support a level, use it: in the v1 blind test the scorer's misses were almost all one or more levels nearer 0 than Ollie, never further out on the same side.

Score	Meaning	Example from the gold set
+5	Votes for a hike against the majority, or explicitly calls for an immediate hike larger than expected. **Votes and explicit calls only.**	Pill, Greene, Mann: voted to raise Bank Rate to 4% against a 6-3 hold (Sep 2026)

Score	Meaning	Example from the gold set
+4	Argues for tightening now or very soon, or that policy is clearly too loose	Mann: "our current monetary policy stance is not sufficiently tight"; Masu: "desirable to raise the policy rate at the earliest stage possible"; Tamura: "accelerate the pace of rate hikes without hesitation"
+3	Argues further tightening is likely needed, or should come sooner than markets expect	Pill: "a prompt but modest hike in bank rate will help mitigate upside risks"; Greene: "Waiting for definitive evidence… would leave policy behind the curve"
+2	Clear hawkish tilt: inflation persistence is the main concern, upside risks stressed, conditional case for tightening	Ramsden: "risks to the inflation outlook… have tilted more to the upside"; Breeden: "if risks… crystallise, it becomes increasingly appropriate for Bank Rate to respond"
+1	Leans hawkish: mild upside-risk language, readiness to act	Bailey: "we are ready to adjust course as needed"; Takata: "the Bank will need to adopt a nimble approach"
0	Balanced, purely data-dependent, or the Governor restating the expected path	Ueda: "the Bank will continue to raise the policy interest rate at an appropriate pace"
-1	Leans dovish: caveats, mild downside or balancing language	Taylor: "an extended hold at this level is… the correct and appropriately measured policy response"
-2	Clear dovish tilt: prefers waiting, growth concerns, inflation not persistent, or wants hikes to stop short of neutral	Dhingra: "continue to see value in waiting for a clearer read"; Takata: "the Bank should not aim to reach the expected neutral interest rate"
-3	Argues policy is tight enough, or easing should come sooner than markets expect	Taylor: "interest rates can and should resume their downward path to neutral"; Bailey: "the paths would point to a looser policy stance than implied by the market curve"
-4	Argues against the next expected move, or for easing soon	Asada: "a rate hike could slow the economy" (Jul 2026, between two dissents against hikes)
-5	Votes against a hike or for a cut against the majority, or explicitly calls for immediate easing. **Votes and explicit calls only.**	Asada: voted against the hike to 1.25% (Sep 2026)

4. Signal dimensions

Read the statement on these dimensions, then combine. The rate-path signal dominates: if a statement states a rate preference, that largely sets the score.

1. **Rate path preference** (explicit, implied, or none)
2. **Inflation assessment** (persistence, second-round effects, expectations)
3. **Growth and labour market**
4. **Balance of risks**
5. **Bank-specific:** BoE quantitative tightening pace; BoJ JGB purchases, yields, yen

5. Interpretation rules

These come from the calibration round. Each one fixes a mistake made at least once.

1. **Score the meaning, not the keywords.** Negation flips the sign. "I do not draw much comfort from the relatively benign developments" is hawkish: the speaker refuses to be reassured by soft data. Never score on words like "benign", "comfort" or "risk" alone.

2. **"Neutral" depends on which side of neutral the rate is.** The BoJ is below neutral, so "move closer to neutral" means hikes (hawkish). The BoE is above neutral, so "resume the downward path to neutral" means cuts (dovish). Check the context block before scoring any statement about neutral.
3. **Policy jargon has a direction.** "Activist move", "risk management strategy", "lean against", "act decisively" and "behind the curve" all point to tightening when inflation is the concern. "Look through", "patience", "extended hold" and "more than sufficient" point to holding or easing.
4. **Inflation persistence is hawkish.** A statement that inflation will stay above target, or that price rises "may not be temporary", scores positive even if it names no rate path.
5. **Conditionals score one level below the same view stated outright.** "If the conflict persists, policy may have to tighten" scores +2, where "policy will have to tighten" would score +3. "I would stand ready to react, forcefully if necessary" scores +3. A conditional in both directions ("risks are two-sided") scores 0 or +/-1.
6. **The ends of the scale are for votes and explicit calls.** Strong speech caps at +/-4. Only a recorded dissent, or an explicit call for an immediate move, earns +/-5.
7. **The Governor restating the expected path scores 0; anyone else arguing for it scores +/-2.** When Ueda says the Bank "will continue to raise the policy interest rate", he is describing committee policy: 0. When a deputy or board member says the Bank "should continue to raise" or "needs to continue to raise", they are taking a side: +2. The same applies in the dovish direction.
8. **Governors and deputies often speak for the committee.** Flag these statements as `institutional`. They keep their score, but the dashboard can weight or display them differently.
9. **Paraphrases score the same way but with lower confidence.** A reporter's summary carries less information than the speaker's own words.
10. **Score the words, not the speaker's reputation.** A known dissenter backing staged hikes is still backing hikes. Their votes already carry their stance into the dashboard, so the words must be scored on their own.
11. **Wanting hikes to stop short of neutral is dovish, even alongside support for near-term hikes.** "Gradual hikes rather than aiming for neutral" scores -2: the cap on where rates end up is the signal, and the near-term hikes are already expected.
12. **Fragments and unclear subjects.** If a statement is a fragment, or its subject is unclear ("if it were to materialise"), score it from the clear part at lower confidence. Use `need_context` only when the direction itself cannot be read.
13. **Score the position, not the shift.** Score where the speaker now wants rates to go relative to market expectations, not the direction they have moved from an earlier vote or speech. Ramsden holding only because of the conflict ("would have otherwise voted for a 25 basis point cut") states a preference for easing that the shock merely delays: -4. Dhingra conceding that worse news "may warrant some further tightening" while seeing "no compelling case to increase Bank Rate pre-emptively" stands against a hike: -2. Pill favouring "a cautious withdrawal of policy restriction" when the market and four colleagues wanted cuts sooner wants tighter policy than expected: +3. The direction of the move a speaker backs does not set the sign; its pace against the market does.
14. **Caveats count on their own words.** A reassurance from a hawk, or a warning from a dove, scores as what it says, with no cap for the speaker's usual side (this extends rule 10). Tamura, who had dissented for a hike, saying the Bank should not "immediately raise the policy interest rate to a restrictive level": -3. Pill's "events in the Gulf have not triggered a de-anchoring": -3.

6. Bank glossaries

Stock phrases and what they usually signal. Each entry is dated because usage drifts. Extend these during calibration.

Bank of England

Phrase	Usual signal	Noted
"gradual and careful"	Neutral to slightly dovish vs a market pricing hikes	Oct 2026
"second-round effects"	Hawkish when the speaker worries about them, dovish when dismissing them	Oct 2026
"look through" (energy prices)	Dovish	Oct 2026
"restrictive" (current stance)	Dovish: implies no need to tighten further	Oct 2026
"risk management"	Hawkish: case for acting before the evidence is in	Oct 2026

Bank of Japan

Phrase	Usual signal	Noted
"adjust the degree of monetary accommodation"	Hike, framed as not a tightening	Oct 2026
"accommodative financial conditions"	Hawkish: room to keep hiking	Oct 2026
"appropriate pace"	Neutral: the expected path	Oct 2026
"not at a fixed pace", "nimble"	Slightly hawkish: open to faster moves	Oct 2026
"negative real interest rate"	Hawkish: real rates too low	Oct 2026
"underlying inflation below 2%"	Dovish: case against hiking	Oct 2026

7. Output schema

Return exactly this JSON for each statement:

```
{
  "score": -2,
  "confidence": 0.7,
  "flag": null,
  "rate_path_signal": "explicit | implied | none",
  "dimensions": {"inflation": -1, "growth": -2, "risks": -1},
  "topics": ["wages", "labour_market"],
  "key_quote": "short excerpt, under 40 words",
  "rationale": "one sentence on why this score",
  "institutional": false,
  "novelty": "new | repeated"
}
```

`flag` is `null`, `"not_policy"` or `"need_context"`. When `flag` is set, `score` is `null`.

8. Version log

Version	Date	Change	Prompted by
v0	2026-10-19	First draft. Scale anchors, rules 1 to 9, glossaries. +/-5 reserved for votes and explicit calls.	Ollie's 126 labels and corrections to 9 of them
v1	2026-10-19	Rule 5: conditionals one level below, not half. Rule 7: Governor restating path = 0, others arguing for it = +/-2. New rules 10 (words not reputation), 11 (stopping short of neutral = -2), 12 (fragments). -2 and -4 anchors updated.	v0 blind test: scorer too dovish on BoJ hike language and conditionals; disagreements on Takata and Sato

Version	Date	Change	Prompted by
v2	2026-10-19	New rule 13 (score the position against the market, not the shift from an earlier stance). New rule 14 (caveats count on their own words, no cap), settling open question 2. Section 3: the tie rule is for genuine ties only. Blind items v1b-boe-04, -06, -12 and v1b-boj-08 are now anchors, so they leave the holdout.	v1 blind test (77% within 1): scorer compressed toward 0; opposite signs on Ramsden, Dhingra and Pill, which Ollie relabelled by position (Ramsden -4, Dhingra -2, Pill +3); Tamura caveat labelled -3

Open questions for v2

Settled in v1: the same words from different speakers (now rule 7). Settled in v2: balancing caveats (now rule 14, no cap); position versus shift (now rule 13).

Still open:

1. **Asada's June dissent** is labelled -4, but rule 6 makes a dissent against a hike -5. Should every dissent be +/-5?
2. *(Settled in v2 by rule 14.)*
3. **Dhingra headline** ("very hard to say... it depends on energy prices") is labelled +2. It reads as 0. Keep or change?
4. **Deputy governors under rule 7.** v1 treats deputies like board members (arguing for the path = +2) because Himino's labels support it. Confirm.
5. **Two-way conditionals against the market.** Ramsden's "If they were to crystallise, a hike in Bank Rate may be warranted. If the risks were to subside... I would consider resuming the cutting cycle" (Jul 2026) is labelled -2; rule 5 gives 0 or +/-1. Probably depends on what the market was pricing, which needs the OIS history before it can be settled.